

SCENARIO IMMERSION PROTOCOL (SIP)

An Experimental Approach to Prevention Training

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This brief proposes piloting **Scenario Immersion Protocol (SIP)** - an experiential training methodology that addresses persistent engagement challenges in prevention education. Rather than transmitting information through lectures or content, SIP creates structured experiences where service members discover their own behavioral patterns around peer intervention, help-seeking, and prevention topics.

The approach:

- 60-minute facilitated scenario experience with 4-6 participants
- Participants take anonymous roles in prevention-relevant scenarios
- Guided choice-making reveals actual behavioral patterns
- Structured debrief connects insights to real behavior change

Pilot scope:

- 2-4 week timeline
- 3 IPPW partners
- ~8 hours Signalform support per IPPW
- Zero new budget (uses existing consulting allocation)

If successful: Scalable methodology for prevention training that actually changes behavior, not just knowledge.

THE PROBLEM

Current prevention training approaches aren't working:

- Service members disengage from PowerPoint lectures and video content
- Information is transmitted but behavior doesn't change
- IPPWs report low participation and Command deprioritization
- Prevention metrics remain stagnant despite educational efforts

The root issue: Standard training assumes a knowledge deficit - if people just *knew* the right thing to do, they'd do it. But behavior change doesn't work that way. Service members already know they should intervene when a buddy is struggling. They know substance abuse is harmful. They know help-seeking is important.

Knowledge isn't the barrier. The actual barriers are:

- Social pressure and peer dynamics
- Fear of consequences or judgment
- Uncertainty about how to intervene effectively
- Disconnect between what people think they'd do and what they actually do

These barriers operate at the level of instinct and social conditioning - not information processing.

THE SOLUTION: SCENARIO IMMERSION PROTOCOL

SIP creates conditions where participants can safely explore their actual behavioral patterns without performance pressure. By placing people in realistic scenarios with genuine choices, we reveal the current "set point" - what people actually do versus what they think they should do.

How it works:

1. STORY CAPTURE (60 minutes)

Signalform facilitates a conversation with the IPPW to understand:

- Specific prevention challenges at their installation
- Local culture and dynamics
- Barriers to intervention and help-seeking
- Previous approaches and what hasn't worked

This session is recorded and transcribed (consistent with previous Story Capture methodology).

2. CUSTOM PROTOCOL DEVELOPMENT (3-4 hours)

Using the Story Capture conversation, Signalform creates:

- **Custom scenario** tailored to that installation's context
- **4-6 choice points** with three options each (spanning proactive, neutral, avoidant responses)
- **Narrative map** showing decision trees and consequences
- **Facilitation guide** with prompts and debrief questions

3. FACILITATOR TRAINING (60-90 minutes)

Signalform trains the IPPW on facilitation approach:

- How to hold psychological safety
- Presenting choices without judgment
- Navigating the decision tree
- Facilitating meaningful debrief

4. SESSION EXECUTION (60 minutes)

IPPW facilitates experience with 4-6 service members:

- **Setup (5 min):** Frame the experience, assign anonymous roles
- **Scenario play (30 min):** Participants navigate 4-6 choice points as their characters
- **Debrief (25 min):** Structured reflection on patterns observed

5. ITERATION

Based on results, refine protocol and scale to additional IPPWs.

WHY THIS APPROACH WORKS

Military already knows scenario-based training is effective: War games, tactical exercises, and simulation-based learning are standard practice. SIP applies this proven methodology to behavioral and psychological training.

Key differentiators from standard scenario training:

Traditional Scenario Training	Scenario Immersion Protocol
Scripted outcomes, "right answers"	Emergent narrative, no predetermined outcome
Performance pressure (doing it "correctly")	Psychological safety (exploration without judgment)
Facilitator as expert/evaluator	Facilitator as guide who holds space

Focus on knowledge demonstration

Focus on pattern revelation

Generic scenarios

Custom-built for specific installation context

The mechanism: By creating **controlled fragmentation** - temporary separation from identity and social expectation through anonymous roles - participants can explore actual behavioral patterns. The debrief makes these patterns visible, which is the moment they become editable.

This is similar to how the military uses After Action Reviews (AARs) - observe what actually happened, reflect on why, adjust future behavior. SIP creates a safe space to observe behavioral patterns before they have real-world consequences.

THEORETICAL FOUNDATION

SIP is based on **Sleepy Planet Protocol** - a collaborative imagination methodology I've been developing for several years as part of my Signalform practice. Sleepy Planet uses guided scenario exploration to reveal subconscious patterns and enable psychological insight.

The underlying principle: humans have behavioral "set points" (default patterns) shaped by environment, culture, and social conditioning. To change behavior, you need to:

1. Make the current set point visible
2. Create conditions where alternative patterns can be explored safely
3. Allow conscious observation of what emerges

SIP adapts this methodology specifically for prevention contexts, using group dynamics and role-based scenarios rather than individual imagination work.

PILOT STRUCTURE

Phase 1: Prevention Champion Council Test (Weeks 1-2)

- Run 2-3 test sessions with PCC volunteers
- Each session: 60 minutes, 4-6 participants, different scenarios
- Gather feedback on experience design and facilitation approach
- Refine methodology based on results

Phase 2: IPPW Training & Co-Facilitation (Weeks 2-3)

- Identify 2-3 interested IPPWs for pilot

- Story Capture session with each IPPW (60 min)
- Custom protocol development for each installation
- Facilitator training (60-90 min per IPPW)
- Co-facilitated session (Signalform + IPPW together)

Phase 3: Independent IPPW Facilitation (Weeks 3-4)

- IPPWs facilitate sessions at their installations
- Signalform provides remote support/observation as needed
- Document results and participant feedback

Phase 4: Assessment & Recommendations (Week 5)

- Analyze engagement metrics and qualitative feedback
 - Document lessons learned and refinements needed
 - Provide recommendation on scaling potential
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SUCCESS METRICS

Immediate (post-session):

- Participant engagement during experience (observable)
- Quality of insights generated in debrief (qualitative)
- Participant feedback: "Was this different from other training?" (survey)
- Word-of-mouth interest (do participants recommend to others?)

Short-term (30 days):

- IPPW confidence in facilitation approach
- Voluntary participation rates (are service members attending willingly?)
- Command perception of value
- Requests for additional sessions

Medium-term (60-90 days):

- Documented behavior change examples (case studies, anecdotes)
 - Changes in prevention-related incidents (if trackable)
 - IPPW effectiveness perception (pre/post survey)
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RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

Pilot Phase:

- **Budget:** Zero new funding required. Uses Mike Marrotte's existing consulting time allocation (24 hours total across 4-5 weeks)
- **IPPW time:** 60-min Story Capture + 60-min training + 2-3 hours session facilitation per IPPW
- **Participant time:** 60 minutes per session
- **Technology:** Zoom (existing), basic recording/transcription (existing)

If Scaling:

- Facilitator training program development
 - Additional Story Capture + protocol development for new IPPWs
 - Potential digital interface development (future state, not required for pilot)
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RISKS & MITIGATION

Risk: Facilitation quality varies, experience falls flat

Mitigation: Co-facilitation model ensures quality in pilot phase. Develop structured facilitation guides with decision trees so IPPWs have clear framework. Continue refinement based on results.

Risk: Service members see this as "touchy-feely" and resist

Mitigation: Frame as tactical scenario training (familiar military concept). Use anonymous roles to reduce vulnerability. Emphasize voluntary participation and psychological safety.

Risk: Difficult to measure behavior change in short timeline

Mitigation: Focus pilot success metrics on engagement and insight quality (measurable immediately). Document anecdotal behavior changes. Long-term impact assessment can follow if pilot succeeds.

Risk: Scenarios not relevant to specific installation contexts

Mitigation: Story Capture process ensures customization. Each protocol built from actual IPPW experience and local challenges. IPPWs review scenarios before facilitation.

NEXT STEPS

Immediate:

1. Review this brief with leadership team

2. Schedule demonstration session (60 min) where Elizabeth, Travis, and key team members experience SIP firsthand
3. Gather feedback and refine approach

If approved:

1. Identify PCC volunteers for initial test sessions (Week 1)
 2. Run 2-3 test sessions and iterate (Weeks 1-2)
 3. Identify 2-3 IPPW pilot partners (Week 2)
 4. Execute pilot structure outlined above (Weeks 2-5)
 5. Deliver results and scaling recommendations (Week 5)
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CONCLUSION

Prevention training needs innovation. Information-based approaches have reached their limit. SIP offers a genuinely different methodology - one that creates experiential conditions for behavior change rather than knowledge transmission.

The pilot is low-risk, low-cost, and immediately executable. It leverages existing resources and proven facilitation methodology adapted for prevention context.

If successful, we'll have discovered a scalable approach to prevention training that actually works - where service members engage willingly, discover their own barriers, and develop genuine capacity for intervention and help-seeking.

I'm ready to demonstrate this approach immediately. Let's schedule a 60-minute immersion session where your team can experience it directly.

Contact:

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Signalform
[contact information]

APPENDIX: SAMPLE SCENARIO STRUCTURE

Context: Service member peer intervention scenario

Roles: 4-6 participants take anonymous role codes (Alpha, Bravo, Charlie, etc.)

Setup: Weekend evening, barracks setting. One person (Delta) showing signs of substance abuse/crisis.

Choice Point 1: Initial awareness

- A) Check in directly with Delta
- B) Mention to another friend, see if they've noticed
- C) Assume Delta's handling it, everyone deals with stress differently

Choice Point 2: (Varies based on Choice 1 outcome)

Choice Point 3: Escalation decision

Choice Point 4: Resolution approach

Debrief explores:

- Why did you choose what you chose?
- What made certain options feel risky or safe?
- How did group dynamics influence choices?
- When have you faced similar situations in reality?
- What would need to be different for you to choose differently?

This brief is based on Signalform's Sleepy Planet Protocol - proprietary methodology developed by Mike Marrotte over several years of practice and iteration.